

ALY WHEALE

Product Design Consultant · Design Systems · Enterprise & Data-Dense Products · AI/ML Tooling

Availability From mid-September 2026 · Consulting engagements or longer contracts · 20–30 hours per week · day rate or fixed scope
Location Greater Boston, MA · fully remote, US
Work authorisation US permanent resident (green card). No sponsorship required.
Contact alywheale@gmail.com · (209) 399-0400
Portfolio alywheale.com

PROFILE

I consult on the parts of a product that are hard to make simple: design systems, complex search and filtering, compliance workflows and machine-learning tooling. 11 years in enterprise software at HP, Micro Focus and Smarsh, first as a front-end engineer and later leading design. I read the codebase and hand over work engineers can build from.

HOW I WORK WITH CLIENTS

- **Design system audit (2 to 4 weeks):** assessing an existing component library, finding the drift, recommending structure, variants, states and documentation.
- **UX audit of a complex product (1 to 2 weeks):** a structured review of search and filtering, dense tables, dashboards, bulk actions and multi-step flows, with prioritised findings.
- **AI/ML tooling interfaces:** model evaluation and comparison, classification review, human-in-the-loop workflows, communicating confidence and error.
- **Embedded design support:** longer part-time engagements alongside front-end teams. Prototypes over specifications.
- **Discovery and concept sprint (about a week):** turning a written requirement or a rough idea into wireframes quickly, so teams can argue about something concrete.

SKILLS

Design Design systems · Component libraries · Interaction design · Information architecture · Data-dense dashboards, tables and filtering · Progressive-disclosure wizards · Wireframing (lo-fi to hi-fi) · Prototyping · Accessibility-conscious design

Research Personas · User stories · Market and competitor analysis · Usability testing · User-group evaluation · Empathy mapping · Storyboarding

Engineering background Computer science degree; shipped production front-end code at HP/HPE (JavaScript, HTML/CSS, Java, Python, Git). Code-literate rather than currently coding. I read a codebase, judge what a change costs, and modify what I need to.

AI-assisted work Prototyping and proof-of-concept builds with AI tooling. Design for ML products: model evaluation, classification review, sentiment and NLP output.

Tools Figma · Sketch · Balsamiq · InVision · Adobe Illustrator/Photoshop · Procreate · Jira/Confluence

Domains Compliance, archiving and supervision · Enterprise search · ML/AI model tooling · Speech analytics, NLP and conversational AI · Contact-centre quality management · Financial services · B2B SaaS

Languages English (fluent) · Russian (fluent) · Spanish (intermediate)

Education MEng Computer Science with HCI and Cognitive Behaviour, University of Southampton, 2009–2013

EXPERIENCE

Independent Designer & Illustrator · Self-employed

May 2025 – Present

- Contract illustration for Derry Comics; scoping, quoting, revision cycles, delivery to deadline.

Senior UI Designer · Smarsh

Feb 2022 – Sep 2024

- **Search redesign (2024):** rebuilt Enterprise Archive search around a single typeahead filter input parsing operators, units and file types into structured filters, with editable filter chips, pinnable saved searches, column toggling and result refinement. Wrote the release documentation.
- **ML model evaluation analytics:** interface for comparing up to four model versions across true/false positive and negative rates on communications datasets, with charted summaries and per-message comparison.
- **Review and supervision workflow:** faceted message search, bulk review actions, flagging for violation, privilege and further review.
- **Case management and policy engine:** legal hold, custodians, case states; drag-and-drop policy prioritisation with dependency and short-circuit handling.
- **Design system:** contributed components and variants to the Angular-based Integrated Design System.

Design Consultant · Soho Squared

2019 – 2022, concurrent

- **Speech² speech-analytics platform:** call search with transcript, waveform and sentiment; agent performance dashboards; real-time Agent Assist with sentiment alerts and de-escalation prompts; entity and policy authoring with regex conditions.
- **Agent evaluation and appeals:** scoring forms with regulation-critical questions, review queues and a supervisor appeal workflow. Figma component sets with variants; identity and colour system.

UX Lead / Senior UX Designer · Micro Focus (now OpenText)

2017 – Feb 2022

- Led design across Digital Safe (private-cloud archiving at scale), Search Optimiser, Answer Bank and Find enterprise search. Ran a team.
- Defined the two-stage UX process used inside the development lifecycle, adopted across product teams.

Software Engineer → UX Lead · HP → Hewlett Packard Enterprise

2013 – Jan 2017

- Front-end engineer, later UX lead, on HPE IDOL big-data and machine-learning analytics applications.
- Designed and shipped the Search Augmentation Tool (successor to Autonomy Business Console) and IDOL Answer Bank.

Earlier · Leto Lab · ECS STACS · Univ. of Southampton. UI Software Engineer; System Administrator; UX Designer (research contract)

2011 – 2013